

the English name James did not exist anciently, and the Greek name is plainly and clearly *Jacob* and so translated, so long as it does not refer to the apostle James or the James the brother of Jesus. It simply makes no linguistic sense.

Unfortunately, the effect is more than a matter of style. The name Jacob is clearly *Jewish*, not Greek or Latin, with deep roots in the Hebrew Bible and Jewish culture. To call Jesus' brother James, in English, dissociates and isolates him from his Jewish environment. But if one begins to use "Jacob" for "James," what tiny measure of familiarity anyone might have with James the brother of Jesus, given his obscurity and marginalization, will completely dissolve. So my first caveat is that I will continue to call Jesus' brother "James," even though it obscures his Jewish heritage.

It is also problematic in this period to use terms such as "Judaism," "Christianity," or even "Judaean-Christian" to describe the emerging movement we come to know much later as Christianity. Neither Jesus nor his first followers understood themselves as part of a new religion called Christianity, and that goes for Paul as well. The word "Christianity" never appears in the entire New Testament and the word "Christian" never in any of Paul's writings. The early followers of Jesus were predominantly Jews, living within a Jewish culture that had as its main reference points Abraham, Moses, the Hebrew Prophets, and Israel as God's chosen people, with the world divided into "Jew" and "Gentile" rather than Judaism and Christianity. If the movement had any name it was most likely "Nazarene," taking its place among a diverse cluster of groups, sects, and movements that make up the variations of "Judaism" in this period.¹¹ Indeed, even talking about the "religion of Judaism" at this time is quite problematic, since those who identified themselves as part of Jewish culture were hardly monolithic or "orthodox" in their practices or their beliefs.¹² I have nonetheless, and quite purposely, chosen to use the anachronistic term "Christianity," or in some cases "Jewish Christianity," for these early stages of the Jesus movement, whether associated with James or Paul. I want to highlight the point that there were rival and competing versions of emerging "Christianity" during this period, each taking Jesus as their reference point, but with distinct and irreconcilable differences, even though in the end this dispute between Paul and the apostles is clearly a Jewish family feud.